

The Sacred Wound

Early in the week, after a sit with this week's recording. Plan on forty-five minutes. Go slowly, and stop if it's too much; that's information, not failure. Keep it. You'll bring a piece of it to your Integration and Next-Step Session.

All month you've been staying with the tightness. Underneath it there's usually something more tender: the ache of all the ways you had to override yourself to belong. This journal turns toward it, sideways and in small doses, the way we've practiced. Not to fix it. To make contact.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Five minutes of breath. Five in, seven out. Note the quality of mind you're starting with. Then open your eyes and begin.



1. THE MOMENT YOU GO FROM FEELING TO MANAGING

Think of a recent moment when your body went rigid, the instant you moved from feeling to managing. The chest tightening in an uncomfortable conversation. The stomach dropping when someone pulled away and you adjusted yourself to stay likable. The jaw clenching as you held back what you really felt. Describe that moment in two or three sentences.

2. THE PROTECTOR FIRST

Close your eyes and let it come back. What shows up first is usually the protection: the mind speeds up, you go blank, there's heat, or the urge to do something. Name it. Which protector is this, and what's it protecting you from? Let it know you see it's trying to help. Then back off to the breath or the hands for a moment.

3. UNDERNEATH

When there's a little steadiness, come back and go a little closer, without forcing. Underneath the protection, what's there? Look for where it's tender, where it aches. Throat, chest, belly, or throughout. What's the quality? How old does it feel? Describe what you find, and if you find numbness or nothing, write that; that's the right answer for now.

4. MEET IT WITH CARE

We don't meet this with cold neutrality. Say to it, in your own words or these: I see you. I'm here. I've got you. Then notice how it responds to being met that way. Does it soften, get louder, move, go quiet? Write what happened.

5. WHAT IT'S BEEN TRYING TO SAY

If the ache could speak, what has it been trying to tell you, maybe for years, that you've been overriding? Don't reach for it from the head. Ask from inside the body and wait. Sometimes it's a sentence, sometimes an image, sometimes a memory. Write whatever comes.

6. WHAT IT WANTS FOR YOU

The ache isn't asking to be silenced. It's asking to be met, and hidden inside it is what you value. What does this part want for you? What has it been longing for? What does it point to that matters most?

7. ONE SMALL STEP

Not a breakthrough or an overhaul. One small step that honors what you used to have to hide. A no, a pause, a let me see, or even a yes. What is it, this week?

8. WHERE YOU ARE NOW

Scan the body. What's there now, compared to where you began? A sentence or two.

TO CARRY INTO THE WEEK

One line. What the wound wants, as best you can hear it right now. That's what you'll bring to the sitting, and to our hour together.